

AYUSHI PARIKH

GAME DESIGNER

+1 (585) 537-8318 | mailayushi15@gmail.com | LinkedIn | GitHub/Korra15 | Portfolio | Blog | Itch

EDUCATION

Rochester Institute of Technology (RIT) <i>MS Game Design and Development, GPA: 4.0</i> Research: Integrating MDA and Design Thinking: A Framework for Early-Stage Player-Centric Game Design.	Rochester, NY Fall 2024 – Spring 2026
MIT Art Design and Technology University <i>B.Tech Computer Science and Engineering, GPA: 9.06/10</i>	Pune, India Fall 2019 – Spring 2023

EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant Casual Game Development, Interactive Media Development, GDD II <i>Unity, C#, Agile, Iterative Design</i>	01/2025 – Present RIT, NY
- Mentored 40+ student developers, providing structured feedback on mechanics, UX, scope, and production workflows. - Evaluated team-based projects using iterative design methodology and agile pipelines, guiding teams in balancing design intent with technical feasibility.	
Graduate Assistant VR Developer <i>Unity, C#, Meta Quest Pro, Interaction Design, Git</i>	08/2024 – 05/2025 Magic Spell Studios, NY
- Developed and optimized a Unity VR research experience for Meta Quest Pro focused on attention-based gameplay systems for kids with ADHD. - Prototyped and implemented interactive objects and core audio-visual feedback loops, rapidly iterating on gameplay interaction design alongside researchers through play-testing.	
Gameplay Designer / Programmer Intern Nodding Heads Games <i>Unreal Engine 4, C++, UEFN, Verse, Tortoise SVN</i>	08/2023 – 06/2024 Pune, India
- Contributed to the PS5 release of Raji: An Ancient Epic, polishing platform features including haptic feedback and RTX rendering improvements across engineering and art departments under senior designer guidance. - Prototyped environment migration workflows in UEFN and recreated gameplay behaviors using Verse scripting.	
Lead Gameplay Designer / Programmer Intern Flege <i>Unreal Engine 4, C++, Agile, Perforce, Design Documentation</i>	05/2023 – 08/2023 Remote
- Led gameplay programming and design for a UE4 simulation modeling Dubai's dynamic real-estate economy. - Designed and implemented core systemic gameplay features including unique traversal mechanics and player controller behaviors. - Oversaw production pipeline and maintained design documentation across the full project lifecycle.	

PROJECTS

Ember's Oath — Capstone Project <i>Game Designer, UI/UX Programmer (Unreal Engine 5)</i>	08/2025 – Present
- Prototyped and implemented design specifications into a playable dynamic phoenix combat character using C++ and Blueprints, integrating melee combat systems, character animation blending, and 3D math-driven aerial movement. - Built modular UI systems and UX flows supporting combat clarity and player progression through comprehensive menu systems in an action-adventure RPG.	
Doom Scroller <i>Technical Designer (Unity)</i>	08/2024 – 12/2024
- Designed and implemented cooperative gameplay mechanics including power-up systems and player coordination loops. - Developed UI/HUD elements improving player communication and gameplay readability.	
Warming Warning <i>Game Designer (Unity)</i>	
- Designed interconnected resource, population, and disaster-response systems for a turn-based roguelike city builder, including population tracking, happiness tracker, resource management, and flood resistance. - Balanced progression systems to reinforce player agency and meaningful decision-making.	

SKILLS

Engines & Tools: Unreal Engine 5, UEFN, Unity, Blueprints, Perforce, Git, Figma
Programming: C++, C#, Python, Verse, JavaScript
Design Focus: Gameplay Systems Design, Level Design, Quest Systems, User Interface Design, Iterative Development
Practices: Agile Development, Sprint Planning, Play-Testing, Design Documentation, Cross-Functional Collaboration